Codebase Guide

SkillHire AI

A guide to understanding the whole project: first the **backend** (ASP.NET Core), then the **frontend** (React). What each folder and file contains, what it does, and how everything connects.

Backend: ASP.NET Core (.NET 10) · Entity Framework Core · SQL Server · JWT
Frontend: React 19 · TypeScript · Vite · Tailwind CSS v4
AI: OpenRouter (free model) · Deploy: Azure (backend) + Vercel (frontend)

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1. Project overview

1.1 What the project does

SkillHire AI is a **job portal**. It has three kinds of users:

Role	What they can do
Employer	Creates a company profile, posts jobs, reviews incoming applications, shortlists / rejects / selects candidates, and schedules interviews.
Candidate	Builds a profile and uploads a resume, searches and applies for jobs, and tracks their applications and interviews. Uses AI to analyze the resume, check skill match, and get job recommendations.
Admin	Sees all users, and approves or rejects jobs posted by employers. Admins cannot register; the system creates the admin account.

Extra features: forgot password (OTP code by email), an email to the candidate when an interview is scheduled or cancelled, dark/light theme, and a "Waking up the server" banner when the free server is asleep.

1.2 Tech stack

Part	Technology	Used for
Backend	ASP.NET Core Web API (.NET 10), C#	REST API: saving data, checking rules, login
Database	SQL Server + Entity Framework Core	Tables. EF Core maps C# classes to tables
Login	JWT token + BCrypt	The token identifies who is logged in. BCrypt hashes passwords
AI	OpenRouter (`nvidia/nemotron-3-super-120b-a12b:free`)	Resume analyzer, skill match, job recommendations
PDF	PdfPig	Extracting text from resume PDFs
Frontend	React 19 + TypeScript + Vite	User interface (pages, forms)
Styling	Tailwind CSS v4	Design, dark mode
HTTP	axios	Sending requests from the frontend to the backend
Routing	react-router-dom v7	Showing the right page for each URL
Hosting	Azure App Service + Azure SQL, Vercel	The live website

1.3 Folder structure

```
SkillHire-Ai/
├── backend/SkillHireAI.API/      ← ASP.NET Core API (C#)
│   ├── Program.cs                ← the app starts here
│   ├── Controllers/              ← API endpoints (URL → function)
│   ├── Services/                 ← business logic (the real work)
│   │   ├── AI/                   ← OpenRouter AI code
│   │   └── Email/                ← email sending code
│   ├── Models/                   ← C# classes for database tables
│   ├── DTOs/                     ← data sent to and from the API
│   ├── Data/                     ← DbContext, admin seeder
│   ├── Middleware/               ← turns errors into clean JSON
│   ├── Migrations/               ← history of database table changes
│   └── appsettings*.json         ← settings
├── frontend/skillhire-client/    ← React app (TypeScript)
│   └── src/
│       ├── main.tsx, App.tsx     ← the app starts here
│       ├── routes/               ← which URL shows which page
│       ├── pages/                ← full pages (admin, employer, candidate)
│       ├── components/           ← small reusable UI pieces
│       ├── services/             ← API calls to the backend
│       ├── context/              ← logged-in user and theme (app-wide)
│       ├── hooks/                ← useApi (loading + error)
│       ├── types/                ← TypeScript types
│       └── utils/                ← small helper functions
├── scripts/                      ← Python test scripts
├── docker-compose.yml            ← local SQL Server
└── README.md                     ← setup and commands
```

1.4 The journey of a request

Say a candidate clicks the "Apply" button. The data flows like this:

```
React page (JobDetails.tsx)
   │  candidateService.apply(jobId, coverLetter)
   ▼
services/api.ts (axios)  →  adds the token header: "Authorization: Bearer <JWT>"
   │  POST /api/candidate/applications
   ▼
ASP.NET Core pipeline (Program.cs): CORS → Authentication (JWT check) → Authorization (role
check)
   ▼
CandidateApplicationsController.Apply()   ← only receives the request and passes it to the
service
   ▼
CandidateApplicationService.ApplyAsync()  ← rules: is the job approved? already applied?
resume uploaded?
   ▼
ApplicationDbContext (EF Core)  →  SQL Server: new row in the Applications table
   ▼
DTO (CandidateApplicationDto) is returned to React as JSON
   ▼
Success message on the page. If a rule fails: AppException → Middleware → error JSON → red
Alert on the page.
```

Key idea: the Controller is thin (HTTP only), the Service holds the real logic, the Model is a database table, and the DTO is the data that goes out. This pattern is the same across the whole backend.

2. Backend (ASP.NET Core API)

Folder: `backend/SkillHireAI.API`. To run it: `dotnet run --launch-profile http`, then test every endpoint in Swagger at `http://localhost:5052/swagger`.

2.1 Program.cs: how the app starts

This is the most important backend file. From top to bottom it does the following:

Section	What happens
Database	Reads `ConnectionStrings:DefaultConnection` and connects `ApplicationDbContext` to SQL Server. `EnableRetryOnFailure` retries automatically on short Azure SQL disconnects.
JWT authentication	Reads the `Jwt` settings (key must be at least 32 bytes). Every request's token is checked: signed with the right key, not expired, correct issuer and audience.
Service registration	Lines like `AddScoped<IAuthService, AuthService>()`. This is called **Dependency Injection**: controllers don't create services themselves, ASP.NET provides them.
Email	If `Email:SmtpHost` is set, uses `SmtpEmailSender` (real email); otherwise `ConsoleEmailSender` (email is printed to the console).
AI	Reads the `AI` section; the key comes only from the `OPENROUTER_API_KEY` environment variable. `AddHttpClient<IAiClient, AiClient>` registers the HttpClient.
Rate limiting	Two policies: **AI** (10 requests per minute per user) and **password-reset** (10 per minute per IP). Going over the limit returns 429 with a friendly message.
CORS	Only the sites in `Cors:AllowedOrigins` (localhost:5173, the Vercel URL) can call the API from a browser.
Controllers + Swagger	Enums are sent in JSON as text (`"Approved"`, not a number). Swagger has an "Authorize" button for the JWT.
Migrations + admin seed	In Development, or when `Database:MigrateOnStartup` is true: tables are created/updated automatically and the admin account is created (if `AdminSeed` is set).
Pipeline (order matters)	ExceptionHandlingMiddleware → Swagger (dev only) / HTTPS redirect (prod) → CORS → Authentication → Authorization → RateLimiter → Controllers.
Health checks	`/api/health` (wakes only the app) and `/api/health/db` (wakes the database too).

2.2 Config files

File	What it is
`appsettings.json`	All default settings, **no secrets**: Jwt issuer/audience/expiry (60 min), CORS (empty), AI (endpoint, model, 90s timeout, 10 requests/min), PasswordReset (10 min code, 5 attempts, 60s resend cooldown), Email (empty SMTP, AppBaseUrl, Asia/Kolkata time zone), Database:MigrateOnStartup.
`appsettings.Development.json`	Local only: Docker SQL connection string, dev JWT key, CORS for localhost:5173, admin seed (`admin@skillhire.ai`). Not used in production.

`Properties/launchSettings.json`	`dotnet run` profiles: `http` → `http://localhost:5052`, Development environment.
`SkillHireAI.API.csproj`	Project file: .NET 10 and NuGet packages (BCrypt, JwtBearer, EF Core SqlServer + Design, PdfPig, Swashbuckle).
`SkillHireAI.API.http`	Sample requests for testing the API from VS Code / Rider (register, login, me, dashboard).
`backend/dotnet-tools.json`	Version of the `dotnet-ef` tool (used to create migrations).

> **Where are the secrets?** Locally: `appsettings.Development.json` and user-secrets. On Azure: environment variables (`ConnectionStrings__DefaultConnection`, `Jwt__Key`, `OPENROUTER_API_KEY`, ...). A double underscore `__` means a nested level in the JSON.

2.3 Models: database tables (folder `Models/`)

Each class is a SQL table. EF Core creates the tables from these classes.

Model / Table	Important fields	Meaning
`User`	Id, Name, Email, PasswordHash, Role, CreatedAt	Everyone who logs in. Passwords are never stored in plain text, only as a BCrypt hash. Role: Admin / Employer / Candidate.
`Employer`	UserId, CompanyName, CompanyDescription, Location, Website, LogoUrl	The employer's company profile (one-to-one with User).
`Candidate`	UserId, Phone, Location, Skills, ExperienceYears, Experience, ResumeUrl, ResumeFileName, ResumeStoredName, ResumeUploadedAt	The candidate's profile. Skills are comma-separated text ("C#, React"). The resume file lives on disk; its name is stored here.
`Job`	EmployerId, Title, Description, Requirements, Skills, Location, SalaryMin/Max, ExperienceRequired, Status, RejectionReason, CreatedAt, UpdatedAt, ReviewedAt	A job post. Status: Pending → Approved / Rejected → Closed.
`Application`	JobId, CandidateId, CoverLetter, Status, AppliedAt, UpdatedAt	Which job a candidate applied to. Status: Applied, Shortlisted, Rejected, InterviewScheduled, Selected.
`Interview`	ApplicationId, InterviewDate (UTC), Type, MeetingLink, Notes, Status, Feedback	Type: Online / InPerson / Phone. Status: Scheduled / Completed / Cancelled.
`ResumeAnalysis`	CandidateId, ResumeFileName, Summary, TotalExperienceYears, ExtractedSkills, Technologies, Experience, Education, Projects, AIResult, Model	Result of an AI resume analysis. Lists are stored as JSON text.
`PasswordResetToken`	UserId, CodeHash, ExpiresAt, VerifiedAt, UsedAt, FailedAttempts	The forgot-password OTP. Only the hash of the code is stored, never the code itself.

Enums.cs	UserRole, JobStatus, ApplicationStatus, InterviewType, InterviewStatus	Lists of fixed values.

```
Relationships:
User 1──1 Employer 1──* Job 1──* Application *──1 Candidate 1──1 User
                                   |
                                   └──* Interview
Candidate 1──* ResumeAnalysis        User 1──* PasswordResetToken
```

2.4 Data folder and Migrations

File	What it does
Data/ApplicationDbContext.cs	EF Core's main class. A `DbSet` for every table (Users, Employers, Candidates, Jobs, Applications, Interviews, ResumeAnalyses, PasswordResetTokens). `OnModelCreating` holds the rules: column lengths, unique email, relationships, delete behaviour, and a unique index so a candidate can apply to a job only once.
Data/UtcDateTimeConverter.cs	Marks every date read from the database as UTC, so the JSON carries the correct time with a "Z" and the frontend can show it in local time.
Data/DbSeeder.cs	Creates the admin account at startup (from `AdminSeed:Email/Password/Name`). Does nothing if the admin already exists.
Migrations/*.cs	History of database changes, one step per file: **InitialCreate** (all main tables: Users, Candidates, Employers, Jobs, Applications, Interviews, ResumeAnalyses), then **EmployerProfileAndJobManagement**, **CandidateApplicationsInterviews** and **ResumeAnalysisDetails** (new columns and rules on those tables), and **PasswordResetTokens** (new table). After changing a model: `dotnet ef migrations add YourName`.

2.5 DTOs (folder `DTOs/`)

DTO = Data Transfer Object. These classes are what travels through the API as JSON. Models are never sent out directly because they contain things like PasswordHash. DTOs also carry validation attributes (`[Required]`, `[EmailAddress]`, `[StringLength]`), so ASP.NET returns a 400 error for bad data automatically.

Folder	Files and purpose
Auth/	`RegisterRequestDto` (role must be Employer/Candidate, password needs a letter and a number, CompanyName required for Employers), `LoginRequestDto`, `AuthResponseDto` (token, expiresAt, user), `UserDto`, `PasswordResetDtos` (forgot, verify-otp, reset).
Employers/	View/update the profile, employer dashboard numbers.
Jobs/	`CreateJobDto` / `UpdateJobDto` (SalaryMax ≥ SalaryMin), `JobDto` (employer/admin view), `JobListingDto` + `JobSearchQuery` (candidate search: search, location, experience, skills, page), `JobStatsDto`.
Candidates/	Profile, profile update, resume upload, candidate dashboard.

`Applications/`	Candidate view, employer view (with candidate details), stats.
`Interviews/`	`ScheduleInterviewDto`, `UpdateInterviewStatusDto`, `InterviewDto` (`candidateNotified`: whether the email was sent).
`Admin/`	Admin dashboard, lists of users, employers and candidates, reject reason.
`AI/`	Requests/responses for resume analysis, skill match and job matches.
`Common/PagedResult.cs`	A paged list: items, page, pageSize, totalCount.
`Validation/NotLessThanAttribute.cs`	Custom validation: one value must not be less than another (e.g. SalaryMax ≥ SalaryMin).

2.6 Controllers: all API endpoints (folder `Controllers/`)

A controller only receives the HTTP request, reads the logged-in user's id from the token (`User.GetUserId()`), calls a service, and returns the result. `[Authorize(Roles = "...")]` above the class says who may call it.

AuthController: `/api/auth` (public)

Method	URL	Purpose
POST	/register	New Employer or Candidate account, returns a token
POST	/login	Email + password → JWT token
GET	/me	Details of the logged-in user (token required)
POST	/forgot-password	Sends a 6-digit code by email (Employer/Candidate only)
POST	/verify-otp	Checks whether the code is correct
POST	/reset-password	Code + new password → password is changed

EmployerController + EmployerJobsController: `/api/employer` (Employer)

Method	URL	Purpose
GET	/dashboard	Job and application numbers, recent items
GET PUT	/profile	View / update the company profile
GET	/jobs?status=	All my jobs
GET	/jobs/{id}	One job
POST	/jobs	New job (starts as Pending)
PUT	/jobs/{id}	Edit a job (editing an approved job sends it back to Pending)
PATCH	/jobs/{id}/close	Close a job

EmployerApplicationsController: `/api/employer` (Employer)

Method	URL	Purpose
GET	/applications?jobId=&status=&search=	Applications received on my jobs
GET	/applications/{id}	Application + candidate profile + interviews
GET	/applications/{id}/resume	Download the candidate's resume
PATCH	/applications/{id}/shortlist · /reject · /select	Change status (rejecting cancels scheduled interviews)
POST	/applications/{id}/interviews	Schedule an interview + email the candidate
GET	/interviews?upcoming=	All my interviews
PATCH	/interviews/{id}	Completed (with feedback) or Cancelled (sends an email)

Candidate controllers: `/api/candidate` (Candidate)

Method	URL	Purpose

GET	/dashboard	Application numbers, latest jobs, upcoming interviews
GET PUT	/profile	View / update the profile
POST GET DELETE	/resume	Upload (PDF/DOC/DOCX, max 5 MB) / download / delete the resume
GET	/interviews?upcoming=	My interviews
GET	/jobs?search=&location=&experience=&skills=&page=	Search approved jobs (paged)
GET	/jobs/{id}	Job details (including whether I already applied)
GET POST	/applications	My applications / apply
GET PUT DELETE	/applications/{id}	View / edit cover letter / withdraw (only while Applied)

AdminController: `/api/admin` (Admin)

Method	URL	Purpose
GET	/dashboard	Numbers for users, jobs, applications
GET	/users · /employers · /candidates	Lists (with search)
GET	/jobs · /jobs/pending · /jobs/{id}	View jobs
PATCH	/jobs/{id}/approve · /jobs/{id}/reject	Approve a job / reject it with a reason

AiController: `/api/ai` (Candidate, 10 requests/min)

Method	URL	Purpose
POST	/analyze-resume	Analyze a PDF (or the saved PDF resume) with AI and save the result
GET	/resume-analysis	The latest saved analysis
POST	/skill-match	`{ "jobId": 5 }` → match %, matched/missing skills
GET	/job-matches?count=5	AI recommended jobs

DashboardController (`/api/dashboard/admin|employer|candidate`): an early test controller that only returns a welcome message, used to test role checks.

2.7 Services: business logic (folder `Services/`)

Each service has an **interface** (`IAuthService`) and a **class** (`AuthService`). Controllers depend on the interface, which makes the code easier to test and change. Every query is filtered by the logged-in user's id, so nobody can see someone else's data (asking for it returns 404).

File	What it does
`AuthService`	Register: lowercases and checks the email (duplicate → 409), hashes the password with BCrypt, creates an empty Employer/Candidate profile based on the role. Login: verifies the password, returns "Invalid email or password" on failure. Both return a token.
`TokenService`	Creates the JWT: claims (userId, email, name, role), HMAC-SHA256 signature, 60-minute expiry.
`JwtSettings, AppClaimTypes`	JWT settings class, and the claim names ("userId", "role", ...).
`ClaimsPrincipalExtensions`	`User.GetUserId()` : reads the user id from the token.
`ProfileLookup`	`db.GetCandidateIdAsync(userId)` / `GetEmployerIdAsync` : user id → profile id.
`EmployerService`	Get/update the company profile, employer dashboard.
`EmployerJobService`	Create a job (Pending), update it (editing an approved/rejected job sends it back to Pending; closed jobs can't be edited), close it.
`AdminService`	Dashboard counts, lists of users/employers/candidates, approve and reject jobs (only Pending jobs; reject needs a reason).
`CandidateService`	Get/update the profile (normalizes skills), upload/download/delete the resume, candidate dashboard.
`CandidateJobService`	Searches approved jobs: text, location, experience, all skills must match, paging. Job details include "already applied" info.
`CandidateApplicationService`	Apply (job must be approved, not applied before, resume uploaded), list own applications, edit cover letter and withdraw (only while Applied), own interviews.
`EmployerApplicationService`	Application list/details, resume, shortlist/reject/select, schedule interviews (future date, valid status) and update their status. Sends emails through `IInterviewNotifier` after scheduling/cancelling.
`PasswordResetService`	OTP: random 6-digit code, SHA-256 hash stored, 10-minute expiry, locked after 5 wrong attempts, 60s resend cooldown. Every response is generic so nobody can find out whether an email is registered. Not available for admins.
`PasswordResetOptions`	Settings class for the limits above.
`ResumeStorage`	Saves resumes in a private folder (not wwwroot). Checks size (up to 5 MB), extension, and the first bytes of the file (so an .exe can't be renamed to .pdf). Saves under a random name.
`JobQueries, ApplicationQueries`	Reusable queries: stats, Job → JobDto, grouping interviews by application.
`SkillList`	Turns text like "c#, React , react" into a clean list (removing duplicates).

2.8 Email services (folder `Services/Email/`)

File	What it does
`IEmailSender`	Interface: `SendAsync(to, subject, body)`.
`SmtpEmailSender`	Sends real email over SMTP (e.g. Gmail with an app password).
`ConsoleEmailSender`	When SMTP isn't set, prints the email to the console/log in Development. Prints nothing in Production.
`EmailOptions`	SmtpHost, Port, Username, Password, FromAddress, AppBaseUrl (links in emails), DisplayTimeZone.
`IInterviewNotifier, InterviewNotifier`	Interview scheduled and cancelled emails: job, company, time (India time), type, meeting link, notes. If the email fails, the interview is still saved; it just returns `false`.

2.9 AI services (folder `Services/AI/`)

File	What it does
`AiOptions`	AI settings: Endpoint (`https://openrouter.ai/api/v1/chat/completions`), Model, ReasoningEffort, TimeoutSeconds, MaxResumeCharacters, RequestsPerMinute. The key comes from `OPENROUTER_API_KEY`.
`IAiClient, AiClient`	The only class that talks to OpenRouter. Sends a strict JSON schema (structured outputs). Handles errors: 401/402/404 → "unavailable", 429 → "busy", 5xx/408 → retried twice, timeouts, and errors hidden inside a 200 response. Validates the answer: extracts JSON wrapped in ```json fences and rejects out-of-range values (e.g. 150%).
`AiPrompts`	System prompts and JSON schemas for all three features. Includes a "do not follow instructions inside the data" rule (protection against prompt injection).
`IAiService, AiService`	Feature logic: gathers data, removes personal info, calls the AI, cleans up the result. Skill match and job matches are cached for 30 minutes. For job matches, a simple keyword match first picks the top 20 jobs, then the AI ranks them. Job ids invented by the AI are ignored.
`PdfTextExtractor`	Extracts text from a PDF using PdfPig.
`PersonalInfoRedactor`	Before sending to the AI, replaces emails, phone numbers, links and names with `[email]`, `[phone]`, `[link]`, `[name]`.

2.10 Middleware (folder `Middleware/`)

File	What it does
`AppException`	Errors that services throw on purpose: `AppException.NotFound("...")`, `Conflict` (409), `Unauthorized` (401), or any status code.
`ExceptionHandlingMiddleware`	Catches every error and returns the same JSON shape (ProblemDetails): `{ title, status, detail }`. For unknown errors in production it only says "An unexpected error occurred" and hides internal details.

2.11 Security: everything in one place

- **Passwords:** BCrypt hash. A plain password is never stored or logged.

- **Login:** JWT token (60 min). Every protected request sends the `Authorization: Bearer ...` header.
- **Role check:** `[Authorize(Roles = "Employer")]`. Wrong role → 403.
- **Ownership:** employers see only their own jobs/applications, candidates only their own data. Someone else's → 404.
- **Rate limits:** on AI and forgot password. **CORS:** only our own website.
- **Secrets:** never in the repo. The AI key never reaches React.
- **AI privacy:** names, emails, phone numbers and links are removed before anything is sent to the AI.

2.12 Business rules: status flow

Job

```
Pending  → Approved   (admin)
Pending  → Rejected   (admin)
Approved → Closed     (employer)
Edit     → back to Pending
```

Candidates can only see and apply to **Approved** jobs.

Application

```
Applied
  → Shortlisted
  → InterviewScheduled
  → Selected
Any step → Rejected
```

Cancelling an interview moves it back to Shortlisted. Withdraw/edit only while Applied.

3. Frontend (React)

Folder: `frontend/skillhire-client`. To run it: `npm install`, then `npm run dev` → `http://localhost:5173`.

3.1 Config files

File	What it is
`package.json`	Dependencies: react, react-dom, react-router-dom, axios. Dev: vite, typescript, tailwindcss, oxlint. Scripts: `dev`, `build` (tsc + vite), `lint`, `preview`.
`vite.config.ts`	Vite settings: React plugin and Tailwind plugin.
`tsconfig*.json`	TypeScript rules (strict mode).
`index.html`	The single HTML page. React runs inside `<div id="root">`. A small script applies the saved theme before the page loads, so there's no white flash.
`.env.example`	`VITE_API_URL=http://localhost:5052` : the backend address. The AI key never goes here.
`vercel.json`	Serves `index.html` for every URL so refreshing a page doesn't give a 404.
`.oxlintrc.json`	Lint (code quality) rules.
`src/index.css`	Tailwind import, brand colours (navy, blue, cyan, violet), and the dark mode variant: `dark:` classes apply when `<html>` has the `dark` class.

3.2 main.tsx and App.tsx

File	What it does
`main.tsx`	The app's entry point. First `wakeServer()` wakes the backend, then `<App />` is rendered into `#root`.
`App.tsx`	Wraps everything: `ThemeProvider` → `BrowserRouter` → `AuthProvider` → `AppRoutes`, plus `ServerWakingBanner`.

3.3 Routes (folder `routes/`)

File	What it does
`AppRoutes.tsx`	All URLs and their pages (list below).
`ProtectedRoute.tsx`	Not logged in → `/login`. Wrong role → `/unauthorized`.
`PublicOnlyRoute.tsx`	For login, register and forgot password: sends already logged-in users to their dashboard.
`rolePaths.ts`	Each role's dashboard path (`/admin`, `/employer`, `/candidate`) and which role can open which path.

Area	URLs
Public	/login, /register, /forgot-password, /reset-password, /unauthorized, * (NotFound)
Admin	/admin, /admin/jobs, /admin/users

Employer	/employer, /employer/profile, /employer/jobs, /employer/jobs/new, /employer/jobs/:id/edit, /employer/applications, /employer/applications/:id, /employer/applications/:id/interview
Candidate	/candidate, /candidate/profile, /candidate/resume, /candidate/resume/analysis, /candidate/jobs, /candidate/jobs/:id, /candidate/applications, /candidate/interviews

3.4 Context: app-wide shared data (folder `context/`)

File	What it does
`AuthContext.ts, AuthProvider.tsx, useAuth.ts`	The logged-in user, `login()`, `register()`, `logout()`. The session is kept in localStorage (`skillhire.session`), so you stay logged in after a refresh. Logs out automatically when the token expires or a 401 arrives. In any page: `const { user, logout } = useAuth()`.
`ThemeContext.ts, ThemeProvider.tsx, useTheme.ts`	Dark/light theme. Adds the `dark` class to `<html>` and saves it in localStorage (`skillhire.theme`). Follows the OS setting the first time.

3.5 Services: API calls to the backend (folder `services/`)

File	What it does
`api.ts`	A single axios instance. Adds the token to every request, tracks slow requests (for the banner), and fires a logout event on 401 (except for the login page's own 401).
`authService.ts`	login, register, me, forgotPassword, verifyOtp, resetPassword.
`employerService.ts`	Dashboard, profile, jobs (create/update/close), applications, shortlist/reject/select, interviews.
`candidateService.ts`	Dashboard, profile, resume (with upload progress), job search, apply, applications, interviews.
`adminService.ts`	Dashboard, users, employers, candidates, jobs, approve/reject.
`aiService.ts`	analyzeResume, getLatestAnalysis, getSkillMatch, getJobMatches.
`fileService.ts`	Downloads/previews protected files (resumes) with the token.
`errors.ts`	`parseApiError()`: turns the backend's error JSON into a simple message and field errors.
`tokenStorage.ts, themeStorage.ts`	Save/load the session and theme in localStorage.
`serverStatus.ts`	Tracks requests longer than 5 seconds (for the banner), and `wakeServer()`.

3.6 Hooks and 3.7 Types

File	What it does
`hooks/useApi.ts`	The standard way to load data: `const { data, error, isLoading, reload, setData } = useApi(() => service.get(), key)`. Every page loads its data with this.

types/*.ts	TypeScript versions of the backend DTOs: `auth`, `job`, `application`, `interview`, `candidate`, `employer`, `admin`, `ai`, `api` (ProblemDetails, PagedResult). A wrong field name gives an error at compile time.

3.8 Utils (folder `utils/`)

File	What it does
format.ts	formatSalary, formatExperience, formatDate, formatDateTime (local time), parseSkills, formatFileSize, emptyToNull.
validation.ts	Form checks: emailError, passwordError, otpError, withoutEmpty.
labels.ts	Friendly names for statuses and interview types ("InterviewScheduled" → "Interview scheduled").
applications.ts	`canScheduleInterview()`: the same rule as the backend, on the frontend.
ai.ts	Colour based on match % (strong/good/low), PDF check (5 MB).

3.9 Components (folder `components/`)

Small reusable UI pieces. Build once, use on every page.

Component	Purpose
`AppLayout`	Layout after login: top navbar (menu depends on role), theme toggle, logout, page in the middle.
`AuthLayout`	Layout for login/register pages (form on the left, brand panel on the right).
`Button, SubmitButton`	Buttons (primary, secondary, danger, success) with a loading spinner. `ButtonLink` = a link styled as a button.
`FormField, TextAreaField, SelectField, SearchInput`	Form inputs with label, error message and hint.
`Alert`	Error / success / info message box.
`LoadingState, ErrorState, EmptyState`	Loading spinner, error with a retry button, "nothing found" box.
`Modal`	Popup dialog (confirm, reject reason, interview outcome).
`PageHeader, StatCard, FilterTabs, Pagination`	Page title, dashboard number cards, status tabs, page numbers.
`StatusBadge, SkillTags, CompanyLogo, Logo`	Coloured status label, skill chips, company logo (initials if missing), app logo.
`ThemeToggle`	Sun/moon button: dark/light.
`ResumePreviewModal`	Shows a PDF resume inside the page; other formats are downloaded.
`ServerWakingBanner`	Shows a "Waking up the server…" banner when a request takes longer than 5s.
`ai/AiLabel, MatchScore`	"AI" marker, and the round ring showing match %.
`ai/ResumeAnalyzerCard`	Card for analyzing the resume.
`ai/SkillMatchPanel`	"How well do I match?" on the job page (AI is called only when the button is clicked).
`ai/RecommendedJobs`	AI recommended jobs on the candidate dashboard (loads separately and doesn't block the page).
`applications/ApplicationProgress, ApplicationStatusBadge`	Applied → Shortlisted → Interview → Selected tracker, status badge.
`interviews/InterviewCard`	Interview card (candidates see job/company, employers see the candidate).

`jobs/JobForm, JobTable, JobListingCard, JobDetails`	Job post/edit form, jobs table for employer/admin, job card in candidate search, job details.

3.10 Pages (folder `pages/`)

Public pages

Page	What it is
`Login.tsx`	Email + password and a "Forgot password?" link. After login, goes to the role's dashboard.
`Register.tsx`	Name, email, password, role (Employers also enter a company name).
`ForgotPassword.tsx`	Enter your email → a code is sent.
`ResetPassword.tsx`	Verify the code, then set a new password.
`Unauthorized.tsx, NotFound.tsx`	Wrong role, unknown URL.

Admin pages

Page	What it is
`AdminDashboard.tsx`	Numbers and pending jobs.
`ManageJobs.tsx`	All jobs, status tabs, approve / reject with a reason.
`ManageUsers.tsx`	Lists of users, employers and candidates.

Employer pages

Page	What it is
`EmployerDashboard.tsx`	Job and application numbers, recent applications, upcoming interviews.
`CompanyProfile.tsx`	Edit company details.
`MyJobs.tsx, PostJob.tsx, EditJob.tsx`	Job list (with close button), new job, edit job (both use JobForm).
`Applications.tsx`	Received applications: filter by job, status and search.
`CandidateDetails.tsx`	One application: candidate profile, resume preview, shortlist/reject/select, interviews (complete/cancel).
`ScheduleInterview.tsx`	Date and time, type, meeting link, notes. After saving, shows whether the candidate was emailed.

Candidate pages

Page	What it is
`CandidateDashboard.tsx`	Numbers, AI recommended jobs, latest jobs, upcoming interviews.
`CandidateProfile.tsx`	Phone, location, skills, experience.
`ResumeUpload.tsx`	Upload the resume (progress bar), preview, delete.
`ResumeAnalysis.tsx`	AI resume analysis: summary, skills, technologies, experience, education, projects.

`JobList.tsx`	Job search with filters and pagination.
`JobDetails.tsx`	Job details, AI skill match panel, apply with a cover letter.
`MyApplications.tsx`	My applications, progress tracker, edit cover letter, withdraw.
`MyInterviews.tsx`	Upcoming and past interviews (feedback shown once completed).

4. Test scripts, Docker and deployment

File	What it does
`scripts/api_smoke_test.py`	All auth, employer and admin endpoints and role rules (83 checks).
`scripts/application_workflow_test.py`	The full candidate flow: apply, applications, interviews (154 checks).
`scripts/ai_features_test.py`	All three AI features against a mock server: privacy, errors, rate limit (151 checks).
`scripts/mock_openai.py`	A fake OpenRouter server (port 5099). Tests AI with no key and no cost. Also simulates errors.
`scripts/password_reset_test.py`	The full forgot-password flow (reads the code from the API log).
`scripts/interview_email_test.py`	Interview scheduled/cancelled emails (42 checks).
`docker-compose.yml`	Local SQL Server container (`skillhire-sqlserver` , port 1433). Start it with `docker compose up -d` .
`README.md`	Setup, all endpoints, commands, configuration, deployment guide.

```
Running locally:
  docker compose up -d                                    # SQL Server
  cd backend/SkillHireAI.API && dotnet run --launch-profile http   # API :5052
  cd frontend/skillhire-client && npm run dev             # React :5173

Live:
  Frontend → Vercel (deploys automatically on GitHub push, VITE_API_URL = Azure URL)
  Backend  → Azure App Service (dotnet publish + az webapp deploy)
  Database → Azure SQL (free serverless, pauses after 60 min idle)
```

5. Full example: from posting a job to the interview email

Step	Where	What happens
1	Employer · PostJob.tsx → POST /api/employer/jobs	EmployerJobService saves the job as **Pending**.
2	Admin · ManageJobs.tsx → PATCH /api/admin/jobs/{id}/approve	AdminService sets the status to **Approved**. Candidates can now see it.
3	Candidate · JobList.tsx → GET /api/candidate/jobs	CandidateJobService searches approved jobs only.
4	Candidate · JobDetails.tsx → POST /api/ai/skill-match	AiService sends the skills and the job to OpenRouter (no name/email) → match %.
5	Candidate · JobDetails.tsx → POST /api/candidate/applications	CandidateApplicationService checks the rules and creates the application as **Applied**.
6	Employer · CandidateDetails.tsx → PATCH .../shortlist	Status becomes **Shortlisted**.

7	Employer · ScheduleInterview.tsx → POST .../interviews	Interview saved, status **InterviewScheduled**, InterviewNotifier emails the candidate, `candidateNotified: true`.
8	Candidate · MyInterviews.tsx	The interview appears. Once completed, the employer's feedback shows too.
9	Employer · CandidateDetails.tsx → PATCH .../select	Status becomes **Selected**.

6. Recommended order for reading the code

Backend

1. `Program.cs`: understand the whole setup
2. `Models/` + `Data/ApplicationDbContext.cs`: the tables
3. `AuthController` → `AuthService` → `TokenService`: the full login flow
4. `EmployerJobsController` → `EmployerJobService`: a simple CRUD
5. `CandidateApplicationService` + `EmployerApplicationService`: the real business rules
6. `Middleware/`: how errors are produced
7. `Services/AI/` and `Services/Email/`: extra features

Frontend

1. `main.tsx` → `App.tsx` → `routes/AppRoutes.tsx`
2. `services/api.ts` + `authService.ts`
3. `context/AuthProvider.tsx`: login state
4. `pages/Login.tsx`: one page from start to finish
5. `hooks/useApi.ts` + any dashboard page
6. `components/`: Button, FormField, Alert
7. `pages/candidate/JobDetails.tsx`: AI and apply together

> **Tip:** Open Swagger (`http://localhost:5052/swagger`) and try each endpoint yourself. Then do the same thing from the React page and watch the request in the browser DevTools **Network** tab. You'll understand the code on both sides together.